Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

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EVALUATOR:

DATE:

PRODUCT:

TASK:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

No major usability issues. Users were generally able to the system's current state through confirmation messages, highlighted navigation elements, vaccination status indicators, and updated appointment information.

Recommendations

Some respondents suggested advanced features and functionalities for the application, but many exceeded the current scope and technical limitations of the prototype.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

Some respondents were unfamiliar with technical terms used in the System Usability Scale (SUS) questionnaire. As a result, a few participants needed additional clarification before answering certain questionnaire items.

Recommendations

Researchers may provide brief explanations of unfamiliar terms before participants answer the questionnaire. This can help respondents better understand each statement while maintaining the integrity of the SUS instrument.

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

Limited undo and redo functionalities made it difficult for some users to fully reverse or recover actions after information had already been entered or confirmed.

Recommendations

Future improvements to the application could include recovery options and more flexible input features, such as action reversal tools and revisable forms, to give users greater control and make error correction easier during interaction with the system.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

No major issues.
Respondents were generally able to understand the interface elements and navigation flow because the prototype maintained uniform design patterns and followed familiar mobile application conventions, making interactions more predictable and user-friendly.

Recommendations

The prototype should continue using consistent visual designs, navigation patterns, icons, buttons, and terminology across all screens to maintain familiarity and ease of use for users.

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

No major issues. The prototype provided warning and confirmation prompts before important actions were performed, helping users review their decisions and interact with the system with minimal input or navigation errors.

Recommendations

The application could strengthen error prevention by improving input checks, clearly indicating required fields, and expanding confirmation steps for critical actions, helping reduce mistakes and improve overall accuracy during use.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Most interface elements, navigation options, and key information in the prototype were clearly displayed and easy for respondents to identify without needing to recall steps or system processes. Users could find vaccination records, appointment details, navigation tabs, and form fields with ease, although one participant initially struggled to spot the “Add Booking” icon due to its low visibility in the interface.

Recommendations

The “Add Booking” icon could be made more prominent by adjusting its size, contrast, labeling, or position within the interface, allowing users to locate it more quickly without external guidance.

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and funtionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The prototype supported standard mobile gestures, enabling users to navigate and complete tasks smoothly with minimal difficulty. It also offered personalized and customizable features, such as pet profiles, vaccination records, and appointment details. However, advanced input shortcuts were not implemented since the system was designed mainly for mobile use.

Recommendations

Future improvements could explore more advanced interaction options to enhance accessibility, convenience, and overall system efficiency for users.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnescessary elements been removed?

Issues

No significant usability issues. The prototype featured a clean, well-organized interface that focused on essential information and core functions, with minimal distractions or unnecessary elements.

Recommendations

The prototype should maintain its clean and minimal design, as this helped users focus more easily on key information and system functions.

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

The prototype included simple confirmation and cancellation prompts to help prevent unintended actions, such as accidentally canceling appointments. However, it offered limited error handling, with minimal guidance, recovery options, or detailed feedback for user mistakes, as it primarily focused on demonstrating core workflows and interface interactions rather than full system functionality.

Recommendations

Future enhancements could strengthen error handling by adding clearer validation messages, visual cues for issues, and guided steps to help users identify and fix mistakes more easily.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The prototype did not provide built-in help features such as guides, tutorials, or searchable support tools, as it mainly focused on showcasing core functions and system flow. Despite this, most users were still able to complete tasks and navigate the interface without needing significant assistance.

Recommendations

Future versions of the application may include help and documentation features such as user guides, FAQs, and contextual instructions to better support users during interaction. Adding these resources could enhance understanding, improve accessibility, and make the system easier to navigate, especially for first-time users.